

Thomas Street Elementary School Handbook 2017-18

Cindy Pike, Principal
520 South Thomas Street
Tupelo, MS 38801
662.841.8960

www.tupeloschools.com

A Note from Your Principal…

Dear Parents,

I am delighted to welcome your child to Thomas Street Elementary School. I truly anticipate an exciting and successful school year. For some of you this will be your first school experience. We strive to make sure every child feels safe, loved, and engaged in learning from the very first day of school. We know that our students are eager to learn, and this inspires us to be creative in our teaching methods. We strive to meet the needs of the individual child in our diverse student body through the use of arts integration, S.T.E.M., and other research based techniques. Beyond academics we stress the importance of assuming responsibility for decisions and being prepared for tomorrow. Encouragement and support are given to each student to reach his/her full potential. I have extremely high expectations for all the Thomas Street staff and students. I also consider it of prime importance that you be an active part of your child's education. Your help and support will not only make your child more successful in school but will instill the value of education in their lives which will last a lifetime.

It is important that you and your child be informed of our standards for classroom behavior so everyone knows what is expected. I have always found parents to be very supportive of good classroom behavior so their child and others have a good environment for maximum learning.

Finally, I want you to know that one of my most important goals this year is to keep the lines of communication open with you. Please contact me at 841-8960 if you have any questions or concerns during the year. Email from outside of our school district sometimes gets blocked, so if you email me and do not get a response, please call the school. I would like to extend an invitation for you to visit your school, to become active members of PTO, to get to know your child's teachers, and to talk with us so we may work more closely together. Our doors are always open − I encourage parent participation − know that you are welcome here! Throughout the school year, we have many special activities, and we are always looking for parent involvement. If you are interested, please contact your child′s teacher.

Please take time to read this handbook thoroughly and discuss it with your child. I consider it a great privilege and responsibility to be your child's principal this year, and look forward to meeting each of you.

Sincerely,
Cindy Pike
Principal, Thomas Street Elementary

Here is a sampling of School – Wide Events at Thomas Street School:

PBS Celebrations	Treasure Tower Trips
Fall Festival	Collecting Box Tops for Education
Hearts for Teachers	End of Year Celebrations
Grade Level Performances	Family Literacy Nights
Grandparents' Day Celebrations	Fall and Spring Book Fairs
Attendance Incentive	Children's Author/Illustrator visitors
Arts Festival	Healthy Tiger Activities
Bob Tarter, The Animal Guy	Tupelo Aquatic Center Water Safety Week
Storyboard Reading Fair	Veteran's Day program
Celebration Village Performance	Children's Symphony
Pumpkin Patch field trip	Healthy Eating/Living Workshop

TPSD BOARD OF TRUSTEES

■■■

Mr. Eddie Prather, President

Mrs. Sherry Davis , Vice-President

Mr. Rob Hudson -Secretary

Mr. Joe Babb
Mr. Kenneth Wheeler

ADMINISTRATION/CENTRAL OFFICE

♦♦♦

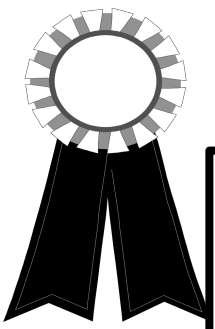
Dr. Gearl Loden, Superintendent
Mrs. Kimberly Britton, Assistant Superintendent
Mr. Andy Cantrell, Assistant Superintendent
Mrs. Anna Guntharp, Assistant Superintendent

Discipline Supervisors
Mr. Andy Cantrell, Secondary
Mrs. Anna Guntharp, Grades K-2
Mrs. Kim Britton, Grades 3-5

TUPELO PUBLIC SCHOOL DISTRICT'S GOALS FOR 2017-2018

These will serve as our blue print in making decisions for our students and staff.

1) Increase student achievement across the District.
2) Provide a safe and orderly environment in all schools.
3) Improve, develop and retain human capital.
4)Improve internal and external communication.
5)Increase management effectiveness and efficiency.



TUPELO PUBLIC SCHOOL DISTRICT MISSION STATEMENT

The Tupelo Public School District serves the community by engaging each student in an excellent education that develops skills and citizenship needed for success in a global society.

Attendance - Tardies, Checkouts, and Absences – Children should be seated in their classrooms by 7:50.
Being late to school is one of our biggest problems. Please, please, please get your child to school on time. Be-

cause instruction is so very important, all children need a full day everyday of instruction. Give your child the gift of knowledge!

Fact: Students who check out frequently, those who are late to school frequently, and those who are absent frequently are more likely to have serious academic problems. Almost all of the children who fall into these categories have to repeat at least one grade before third grade. As a parent you owe your child support in getting to school on time, being at school everyday, and staying at school all day.

Rules and procedures are in place for the children's safety and to ensure good conduct among the students. Each teacher sets a standard of conduct for students they are expected to follow. The guidelines below provide the general expectations our teachers have for our students. Please discuss these guidelines with your child to ensure a successful school year. Question your child to be sure he/she understands the teacher's expectations.

When students are unable to follow guidelines, appropriate discipline will be administered. Schools follow TPSD Discipline policy JD for Elementary Students in grades K-2, Policy JDD for Suspension, and JCAA for Due Process. Students who follow the rules are often rewarded with tokens, PBS incentives, and classroom rewards.

Encourage your child to make good choices in behavior *every* day!

Promoting and Reinforcing Personal Responsibility for Learning, Positive Behavior, and Good Citizenship

In the Tupelo Public School District, students are expected to exhibit responsible behavior and to maintain positive attitudes that will contribute to their own well-being as well as the well-being of others. One goal is to promote an atmosphere within the schools conductive to learning, and another is to help children become responsible for good personal conduct at school.

Each school has a certified guidance counselor who provides one-on-one and group counseling. As part of the curriculum, the guidance counselor also conducts classes for the students. These lessons focus on the monthly character traits for the district.

Character must be consciously taught, developed, and practiced. This teaching has always been a parent's job. But there are also critical supporting roles to be played by everyone in a community. After all, character really counts in school, in the workplace, and in life. Acknowledging student demonstrations of good character is important. We expect the student to do the right thing even when there's no one around and there will be no immediate reward. Therefore *recognition* is emphasized more than *reward* when it comes to reinforcing positive character traits for long-lasting effects. Examples of recognition strategies abound. Students and Employees of the Month, assemblies, parties, and PBS events are great opportunities for school communities to celebrate progress and publicly acknowledge TPSD's commitment to character education.

Drug abuse prevention instruction is incorporated into the regular classroom through the use of a curriculum that is taught by the teachers. In addition, Red Ribbon week is celebrated at each school annually. During this week, special activities are planned that emphasize drug and alcohol prevention.

Bullying prevention and violence prevention activities are emphasized throughout the school year. Activities district-wide, school-wide and in the classrooms teach and reinforce the importance of respect and treatment of others. Students are taught the importance of treating others with kindness and respect.

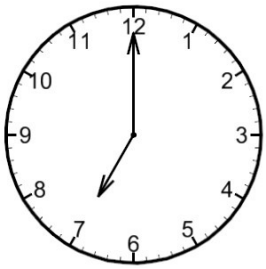
The Tupelo Public School District and Tupelo Police Department school resource officers (SRO) work with students K-12 to develop positive habits and behaviors. This enables our students to deal with character issues

directly and at an age that is developmentally appropriate. Our students work with a good role model in a positive environment. Through many learning opportunities, TPSD emphasizes teaching and recognizing positive behaviors and good citizenship.

ARRIVAL TIME

The safety and security of our children is our top priority! **Adult supervision begins at 7:15 each morning.** Please do not drop off a student until a staff member is outside at carpool. Carpool students should be dropped off in the carpool lane on Bryan Street. Bryan Street is a one-way street in the morning and afternoon during carpool. **Please do not enter the staff parking lot to drop off or pick up students. If you see this happening, it is our handicapped students being brought in by parents.** Never attempt to drop off or pick up your child from the street. This is a direct violation of child safety. Bus riders and Day Care riders will unload and load from the drive-through at the front of the building on Thomas Street. Only buses and vans may drop off in the front from 7:15-7:30. **Beginning at 7:30**, cars may drop off in the drive-through at the front.

Breakfast service begins at 7:15 a.m. The cafeteria will stop serving breakfast at 7:40 a.m. **Students who desire breakfast and arrive at school after 7:40 a.m. will be provided a** "**grab and go**" **breakfast.** Students will be allowed to enter their classroom at 7:30 a.m.; **instructional time begins promptly at 7:50 a.m.**



TARDY

A student is considered tardy if he/she arrives to school after 7:50. Unexcused tardies are calculated each nine weeks and parent letters/conferences will begin at 5 tardies. The attendance officer is notified at 5 unexcused tardies also. **If the student is tardy, the parent is required to walk his/her child into the school and sign him/her in.** Please do not drop off your child in front of the building after 7:50; there will not be a staff member present there to ensure the student's safety.

Staff members are out front from 7:15 until 7:50 am to help children get into the building safely. Children are allowed to open their own car doors and exit onto the sidewalk. Staff members will open the car doors to expedite the process. When there is a long line of cars, it is preferable that children open their own car doors, so that they can get into the building in a timely manner. Parents should pull up as far as possible so that several children at a time can unload.

DISMISSAL

All students are dismissed at 3:05 p.m. Students will be dismissed to **authorized persons only** as indicated on the student information/ emergency form. A carpool sign will be provided for you to keep in your vehicle to assist us in loading your child. Always notify your child's teacher, **in writing**, of any change in procedures or change in person(s) picking him/her up. Students will be dismissed in the same way every day unless written notice is received informing us of the change. It is urgent that parents pick up students promptly after the 3:05 afternoon dismissal. For the safety and protection of the children, all students who have not been picked up by

3:25 p.m. will report to the office. Any student picked up after 3:25 p.m. must be signed out by an authorized adult.

EARLY DEPARTURE FROM SCHOOL

Parents are strongly encouraged to try and schedule their child's doctor, dental, and other appointments after school hours. If this is not possible, send a note to the teacher on the day of the appointment. Upon arrival, come to the office to sign your child out. While you are signing the checkout sheet, the secretary will page your child to come to the office. The school office is extremely busy from 2:30 p.m. through dismissal. Checkout for K-2 students after 2:30 p.m. will not be permitted unless there is a doctor's appointment or an emergency. **Getting to school late or leaving early is detrimental to the education of your child. Please help us model respect for the school day. Instructional time is valued and protected by our staff.**

A parent or guardian must sign out students who are leaving school during school hours. Only persons listed on the student emergency card will be allowed to check the student out.

Please respect our instructional time.
Getting to school 15 minutes late and/or checking out 15 minutes early are detrimental to the education of your child.

MISCELLANEOUS INFORMATION

Visitors to School

The principal is responsible for all persons in the building and on the campus and will schedule through his/her designee visits from parents, community members, and other educational professionals. The following policy applies to all visitors entering a school other than for attendance at a scheduled activity open to the general public:

In order to assure that no unauthorized persons enter the school with wrongful intent, all visitors will report to the school office when entering to receive authorization and identification passes to visit elsewhere in the building.

Parents or citizens who wish to observe a classroom while school is in session must arrange such visits in advance with the principal so that classroom disruption will be minimal. Principals are authorized to refuse entry onto school grounds to persons who do not have legitimate business at the school and to request any unauthorized person or persons engaging in unacceptable conduct to immediately leave school property. Principals are further authorized to request assistance of law enforcement officers in cases of emergency and to seek prosecution to the full extent of the law when persons violate the intent of this policy.

Attendance – JBD TPSD Board Policy

To be considered as having attended school for a full day, a student must be present for 63% of his/her instructional day as fixed by the Board for each individual school. For purposes of reporting absenteeism, a student who has an absence that is more than 37% of the student's instructional day shall be considered absent the entire school day.

1. Excused Absences shall include:

a. Parental Excused Absences

Students are allowed to have a maximum of three (3) excused parental absences per semester. Parental absences must be substantiated in writing within 2 school days of the absence. A parent/guardian can substantiate the absence by sending a signed note, emailing or faxing to the school attendance office. The note must have the child's name and date of absence(s). A parent signed checkout will also substantiate a parental ex-

cused absence if requested. A parental excused absence may be for one class, any 30-minute period within a class or an entire day.

b. Medical Excused Absences
Students are allowed excused medical absences when the absences result from illness or injury which prevents the student from being physically able to attend school; a medical or dental appointment; isolation ordered by the county health officer, and State Board of Health or appropriate school official. Excuses from the doctor or dentist must be substantiated in writing within 2 school days of the absence.

2. Unexcused Absences- Any absence, tardy or dismissal, which does not meet the criteria of an excused absence, shall be considered unexcused. No absence will be considered excused when it is due to suspension, expulsion or other disciplinary action.

Unexcused absences – **Parents will be contacted when a student has 3 unexcused absences and an overnight required conference will be entered into the discipline record. At 5 unexcused absences and at 7 unexcused absences, a parent will be required again to come in for a required conference. At 7 unexcused absences, a parent will have to sign a contract at that conference.**

Attendance is extremely important and any absence hampers a student's academic progress. Family vacations should be scheduled for summers or other times that school is not in session. Each month has some type of holiday or three-day-weekend. Please use these times for your travels.

CAFETERIA INFORMATION

All students will be given an application for free and reduced lunches. Children who participate are not labeled or treated differently. The Thomas Street Cafeteria serves two meals each day. Breakfast is served from 7:15 a.m. until 7:45 a.m. each day. Lunch is served between 10:45 a.m. and 12:45 p.m. The menu is published weekly in the local newspaper and on the district's web site www.tupeloschools.com. Although meals may be purchased on a daily basis, students are encouraged to pay by the week. Money is collected on Monday mornings. Students who choose to bring their lunch are encouraged to pack a healthy, nutritious meal. They may purchase milk from the cafeteria. The Tupelo Public School District is now using www.myLunchMoney.com, a service to prepay for your child's breakfast, lunch, and extra sales items using your credit card. The site is easy to use and offers a convenient and secure way to check balances and fund your account from your computer, phone or fax.

Each day students will have a snack/milk break. Students may bring a healthy snack to school.
Parents and other visitors who wish to eat lunch in the cafeteria should notify the office by 8:30 a. m. on the day of the visit with a note or a phone call. The cafeteria must have a lunch count each morning.
Current meal prices can be found on www.tupeloschools.com under Child Nutrition.

DELIVERIES

In the interest of safety to students and to avoid interruptions during instructional time, deliveries of balloons, flowers, gifts, etc. will not be accepted at school. Please have deliveries made to your child's home. Cupcakes, cookies, etc. must be store bought for the entire homeroom class. These will be distributed during snack time to avoid interruptions with instructional time. Cupcakes and snacks may no longer be served at lunch or up to an hour before lunch. Invitations to birthday celebrations cannot be handed out at school.

DRILLS

Thomas Street School will conduct monthly safety drills according to state regulations. We will have fire drills, tornado drills, lockdown drills, and earthquake drills. These drills are in place to help students and staff know

what to do in case a real situation occurs. We encourage students to stay calm and follow procedures. If you are in the building during one of these drills, you will be asked to participate also.

GRADE LEVEL PERFORMANCES

Every student in each grade participates in a performance each year. Being in a performance provides the opportunity for each child to perform in front of an audience. This builds self-confidence in our students and teaches students not only to perform, but proper audience etiquette as well.

EVACUATION SITE

IN case of evacuation of the building due to a fire or other threatening situation, we will walk to **The Church of Jesus Christ of the Latter Day Saints on South Thomas Street** to remain there until our building is pronounced safe by the police department. If the entire area is unsafe, the whole school will be bused to Lawndale Presbyterian Church. Students should be picked up at one of these locations according to school procedure. Our main goal is to keep our children safe. Please help us accomplish this with your cooperation.

LOST AND FOUND

Articles found in and around the school should be turned into the office. Owners may claim their property by identifying it. Be sure to label your child's coats, jackets, sweaters, and backpacks**.** Unclaimed clothing will be donated at the end of each month. Parents are always welcome to come by and check the items in the back of the stage.

MEDIA CENTER

Our Media Center gives students the opportunity to enter the magical and exciting world of reading. Our Media Center is home to hundreds of fiction and non-fiction works. There is also a vast selection of books that are part of our collection program, which are conveniently organized so that students have an easy time selecting books at their reading level. Students will also have time to work on computers during their media time.

Children may get a library pass from their teacher from 8:00-10:00 to visit the Media Center to check out books. Classes are scheduled into the media center the remainder of the day.

PARENTS AND OTHER VISITORS

All visitors must use the front entrance and report to the office. A visitor's badge must be worn so that staff and students will know that the visitor has been cleared through the office. This procedure is imperative in our efforts to keep unauthorized visitors out of the building.

We want to emphasize the importance of our instructional time. Please understand that it is necessary to schedule conferences and classroom visits in advance with your child's teacher. If you are visiting or helping in a classroom, this is not the time to conference with a teacher.

PARENT/VISITOR PARKING

Please do not park in front of the school during drop off and pick up times. This will block the traffic flow and can become a safety hazard.

PERSONAL ITEMS

Children should bring to school only the materials/supplies that are necessary and requested. Items that are distracting to others and disruptive to the learning process are considered nuisance items and should not be brought to school. Toy guns, toy knives, whistles, chewing gum and fad toy items are examples of distracting materials.

Bringing some of these items may result in severe disciplinary actions. Because of the possibility of loss or damage, radios, CD players, cell phones, iPods, large amounts of money and other items of significant value should not be brought to school. *The Tupelo Public School District is not responsible for the loss of such items.*

PLACEMENT POLICY

Children are randomly placed in classrooms with consideration of confidential information from parents and teachers. Requests for specific teachers are not accepted.

STUDENT WITHDRAWALS

If you need to withdraw your child from school, come by the office to inform us of the date your child will be withdrawing and the new school the student will be attending. The counselor will complete a withdrawal form for the student to take to his new school. Student records are sent to the new school upon request. Remember to bring all textbooks and library books to school.

STUDENT APPEARANCE

It should be a matter of personal pride for a student of the TPSD to maintain high standards of neatness and appropriateness of dress and appearance. Parents will be called to bring a change of clothing to the school if a student is not dressed appropriately. The full student dress code policy (JICA) can be found on the TPSD website.
http://tupelo.msbapolicy.org/default.aspx

STUDENT HEALTH /SCHOOL NURSE PROGRAM

The health of your child is important to all of us. Children who have definite signs of colds or other illnesses should not be sent to school. If a child becomes ill or is injured at school, he or she will be cared for temporarily. Parents will be notified and expected to pick up the child. **It is crucial that emergency telephone numbers are kept current.**

Students who are on medication should have a written permission slip and a copy of the doctor's orders on file in the principal's office. Medication must be in a pharmacy-labeled bottle or container, which will be kept under lock and key and administered only by a designated adult. Headache medication, cough drops, etc. are not available at school.

Thomas Street Elementary School focuses on health education and prevention. The preventive measures include routine screening for vision, hearing, and personal hygiene. The health center nurse also serves as a health resource for problems or illness that may be detected.

TUPELO PUBLIC SCHOOLS' INCLEMENT WEATHER PROCEDURE

It will be our practice to always put the safety of our students and staff first in dismissing school for reasons caused by inclement weather. We carefully check the conditions for transportation and make the decision to dismiss school after we have considered all of the information available. Parental discretion is encouraged in cases regarding safety in unusual, specific situations. The final decision for a child to attend school or not during inclement weather rests with the parent.

There are some times when major thoroughfares are kept open, and we have school when some roads are still frozen. It is our plan to keep bus travel on open roads, where no dangers exist in order to complete a school day. We would not want to miss an entire day because of frozen conditions on just a few minor streets.

If inclement weather should occur during the day and it becomes necessary to close school early, an announcement will be made by Central Office. All local news media will be notified by his office, and radio and television stations will announce the decision for early dismissal. Parents will be notified with a phone call so please keep phone numbers current. School closings or early dismissals will also be announced on the TPSD website. Every precaution will be taken to ensure the safety of all students.

Students will not be allowed to leave the school campus if a tornado warning is in effect. Parents are welcome to come inside the building to stay, but students may not leave until the warning is lifted.

The local media that will be notified is listed below:

- Television: WTVA, broadcast channel 9 and cable channel 6 AND WCBI, broadcast channel 4 and cable channel 13
- Radio − WTUP/WESE, WELO/WZLQ, WWKZ, WYSE, WPMX/WWZD, WFTA/WFTO, WWMS, WAFR
- Newspaper − Northeast MS Daily Journal

PARTNERS IN EDUCATION

ACADEMIC AND BEHAVIOR INTERVENTIONIST

Interventions are provided for students who are experiencing difficulty in academics or with behavior. Also, the interventionists provide support for classroom teachers to prevent disruption of instruction. The Academic/Behavior Interventionist provides interventions for students on Tier II & Tier III.

RESPONSE TO INTERVENTION (RTI) is a group of educators who meet to determine interventions for students who are experiencing difficulty in the classroom. Interventions are developed to assist the student in becoming successful. Parents will always be notified of the RTI (Response to Intervention) process. Parents are encouraged to attend these meetings.

- **INSTRUCTIONAL INTERVENTION** is one-on-one or small group instruction designed to assist students who have been referred to the Teacher Support Team.

GUIDANCE SERVICES

Thomas Street School has a certified guidance counselor. Each child at Thomas Street School has access to our school counselor. Parents who wish to arrange a conference with the counselor are asked to call the school office at 841-8960. Additional student services are provided by a Life Core Support Therapist.

The Junior Auxiliary and the Women's Club provide…

- Clothes Closet ☙ Parents may schedule an appointment with the instructional coach for a visit to the Junior Auxiliary Clothes Closet. Children can be fitted with 3 sets of clothing twice per year.
- Medical/Dental/Eye Exams ☙ emergency care can be provided. (School Nurse will help with this.)
- Christmas Assistance ☙ Christmas assistance is provided for families in need.
- Jeans and coat drives are conducted during the year so items can be distributed to students in need.

HIGHLY QUALIFIED TEACHERS

In the Tupelo Public School District teachers must have a minimum of a bachelor's degree. Teachers with three years of experience may complete the national board certification process. District teachers participate in many days of professional development every school year.

PARENT – TEACHER CONFERENCES

Communication between the school and home is an essential part of the educational process. Schools rely on conferences to supplement report cards or portfolios and other written forms of communication between parents and teachers. Parents or teachers may request conferences. Parents wishing to arrange conferences should contact the school secretary during the school day or email your child's teacher. Please allow 24 hours for the teacher to respond. If you feel you need to meet more often, please contact the teacher.

PARENT TEACHER ORGANIZATION (PTO)

The PTO is an organization of parents and teachers who work together to improve and enhance the school environment. Everyone is invited to join the PTO and share in the partnership of support. Through general meetings, emails, phone calls and newsletters, parents are kept up-to-date on plans and progress of our school and school activities.

The PTO sponsors several projects during the school year such as:

- Box Tops for Education
- Fundraisers
- Valentine Hearts
- End of the Year Celebrations
- Arts Festival
- Book Fairs
- Teacher Appreciation Events
- School Yearbook
- Tiger Trot
- PBS Incentives

Box Tops for Education – Each box top you send in is worth 10 cents to us. General Mills sends us cash for the box tops we send in. It's an easy way to raise money. Please collect box tops, glue them to the page sent out, and turn them in to the big mailbox.

THOMAS STREET SCHOOL FIELD TRIP GUIDELINES

- Field trips are designed to enhance and enrich learning.
- Field trips may be used to develop background knowledge at the beginning of a unit of study or to culminate a unit of study.
- Building community within the class and/or grade is also a goal of field trips. Riding the bus and following the trip itinerary contribute significantly to the accomplishment of this goal.
- Chaperones are critical partners in the success of a field trip and assume significant supervisory responsibilities under the direction of the lead teacher.
- Chaperones need to be approved by Central Office through a **background check**. These forms should be filled out early in the school year. Please see School Board Policies on the district website. www.tupeloschools.com
- Participation in the field trip is limited to students, school personnel, and approved chaperones.
- Chaperones will be given specific directions for performing field trip duties.
- Students should ride to and from the destination in the transportation provided by the Tupelo Public School District.
- Only school personnel and students may ride in buses owned by Tupelo Public School District.
- Chaperones may ride in chartered buses as long as there is available space.
- Students should not ride in private cars unless it is with a parent and prior approval is given. A permission form completed and approved at least one week prior to the trip is required. Permission will be granted if the student must leave the field trip to attend a sporting event, academic competition, or organizational event and the form has been completed.
- Students MUST have a completed permission form in order to go on any field trip.

Medications

Parents must request in writing that medication prescribed for their child be provided by school officials and must read and sign a copy of this policy, which will be kept on file by the principal.

Medicines must be brought to the principal or designee by the parents in the original container with the pharmacy information label attached listing the name of the prescribing physician, name of the medicine, dosage and instructions for administration.
1. The instructions should be specific, such as "before meals" or "with food," etc.
2. Medicines will only be administered in accordance with the specific instructions on the original container pharmacy label.
3. No more than a forty-five (45) school day supply of medication will be stored at the school. The principal or designee should return to the parent, or destroy with permission of the parent, any unused, discontinued or obsolete medication.
4. Medicine which is not repossessed by the parent within seven (7) days of notification by school authorities will be destroyed by the principal or designee in the presence of a witness.

If the student's physician has prescribed an over the counter medication for the student, it must be in an unopened, original container, with a pharmacy label showing the student's name, directions for administration and the recommended dosage. If the prescribing physician has given the parent a sample medication, the container must be labeled as stated herein.

Self-Administration of Asthma and Anaphylaxis Medication
Students may self-administer asthma and anaphylaxis medication only in accordance with state law and Board policy. Each student with asthma or anaphylaxis is required to have an Asthma Action Plan (AAP) or Allergic Reaction Care Plan (ARCP), signed by his/her healthcare provider and updated annually, on file at the student's

school. Neither the District nor its employees shall, by law, be liable for any injury sustained by the student who has self-administered asthma or anaphylaxis medication.

Access to all stored medication will be limited to the principal or designee who will witness the administration of the medication.

The following procedures will be followed in case of a medical emergency as may be deemed appropriate:
* Call 911
* Notify school nurse
* Notify parent/guardian
* Notify private physician

"SPECIALS"

➢ ***Art***

Our students participate in art class every rotation. In this class students gain a better understanding of principals of visual art including color, design and art history. In art, the children learn a variety of techniques such as: water coloring, shading, dimensions, and others. The artwork of our students can be found at the Tupelo High School Performing Arts Center, our school building, and, in the spring, at the Gum Tree Museum of Art.

➢ ***Music***

In music class, students explore different styles and genres of music through singing, listening, playing instruments, and movement. Musical skills are developed using the Orff approach as well as traditional methods. Second grade students perform several times throughout the school year at various places in the community, as well as at school. Being a part of this performing group provides opportunities to develop vocal and dance performance skills.

➢ ***Physical Education***

Physical Education classes provide a time for exercising and participating in cooperative games, as well as competitive games. Students learn the importance of good sportsmanship and physical exercise. Students will move to music. Our school offers classes that provide cognitive content and learning experiences in a variety of activity areas such as basic movement skills, physical fitness, rhythms and dance, and games. Through many planned physical activities, each student should reach the optimum physical, mental, emotional, and social development. Students are encouraged to wear comfortable shoes and clothes – dresses are not a good idea on P.E. day. Please let us know if your child ever has any special needs (injuries, sickness, etc.).

➢ ***Computer Lab***

All students will attend computer classes in the computer lab. Thomas Street Elementary School is committed to preparing its students for a world of technology by providing instruction in computer ethics, care, and use. Students become familiar with the different parts of the computer and are taught how to navigate the keyboard properly. Classroom teachers utilize the computer lab for additional instruction. Academics taught in the students' homeroom classes are also incorporated into the computer lab through instructional software. Each individual classroom is also equipped with its own computer station.

➢ ***Media Center***

Every child has an organized time to visit the media center; however, all children have access to the media center every day. During media class, the children learn how to utilize the media center more efficiently and check out books. Books may be checked out anytime between 7:45 and 2:45. All books are due in one week but may be returned early or renewed if extra time is needed.

Other specials may be added depending on the number of homerooms per grade level. These could include Science Lab and Math Chromebook Lab.

After School Clubs (may include these or possibly others)

- ***Art Club***
- ***Book Club***
- ***Fitness Club***
- ***STEM Club***
- ***Recycling Club***
- ***Technology Club***

Family Education Rights and Privacy Act

The Tupelo Public School District routinely makes public certain directory information regarding students. This directory information includes the student name, address, telephone number, picture, height and weight of athletes, extracurricular activities, awards, honor rolls, electronic listings, Internet web pages, and other information which is typically found in school yearbooks, programs, bulletins, and student newspapers. In addition, the District discloses names, addresses, and telephone numbers to military recruiters upon request. Parents and eligible students shall have from **July 15 until September 1** to review this notice and request in writing that all or any part of the directory information not be disclosed without prior written consent.

Curriculum

With a published curriculum from TPSD Curriculum Department for grades K-6 that focuses on reading and mathematics, students receive a solid foundation in the basic skills through a variety of instructional techniques based on MS College and Career State Standards. A licensed teacher staffs each regular classroom. A media specialist, guidance counselor, principal, and support staff support teachers with the needs of all children. All schools also offer physical education, music, and art.

Literacy Statement

Beginning in the 2014-2015 school year, a student scoring at the lowest achievement level in reading on the established state assessment for 3rd grade will not be promoted to 4th grade unless the student meets the good cause exemptions for promotion.

Challenge

The Challenge Program is provided for intellectually gifted children in grades two through eight in the Tupelo Public School District. Students are screened in first grade through teacher observations, group intelligence tests, and achievement tests. In some circumstances, students are screened in higher grades. Students who are referred for testing take an individual intelligence test. Regulations from the Mississippi Department of Educa-

tion require that all children score at or above the 90th percentile to be eligible for the Challenge Program. Students who are in the program meet for five hours each week with the Challenge teacher.

Non-discrimination

The Tupelo Public School District does not discriminate on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex, religion, creed, marital status, veteran status, disability, or age in its programs and activities. The following person has been designated to handle inquiries regarding the nondiscrimination policies:

Director of Human Resources

TPSD Administrative Office
Post Office Box 557
Tupelo, Mississippi 38802
662-841-8850

Asbestos Notification

In accordance with the Asbestos Hazard Emergency Response Act (AHERA) regulations established by the EPA, all school districts are required to provide an annual notification to all parents, teachers, and employees regarding our asbestos management program. This annual notification informs all persons of their option to review the Asbestos Management Plan for our school district.
To provide continuing management of the asbestos in our schools, all Asbestos-Containing Materials (ACM) are inspected every six months by an accredited asbestos inspector. Any changes to these materials are recorded in a surveillance report as part of the management plan.
Additionally, an accredited Asbestos Management Planner conducts a comprehensive inspection of all ACM's every 3 years. This 3-year re-inspection has been performed as required and a copy has been filed with the Mississippi Department of Education.
A copy of the Asbestos Management Plan is located in the principal's office at each school. In addition, copies of all Asbestos Management Plans for the district are maintained in the Superintendent's office located at 72 South Green Street. If you are interested in reviewing this information, please contact the Central Office at 662-841-8853 to schedule an appointment.

Title 1:

Parent Right to Know

The qualifications of teachers and paraprofessionals employed in schools funded by
Title I will be provided upon parent request. Title I School wide Programs are available at the Early Childhood Education Center and the eight K-5 elementary schools. For further information, please contact the principal of the school where your child attends or the Director of Federal Programs. In addition, a parent may request information on the level of achievement of the parent's child on each state academic assessment, and/or a timely notice that the parent's child has been assigned or has been taught for four or more consecutive weeks by a teacher who is not highly qualified.

Home Changes

Parents are reminded that if their homes situation should change, they should notify the school counselor. Students who become temporarily displaced or who are in crisis situations may be eligible for services under the McKinney-Vento Act. The McKinney-Vento Act details rights for students experiencing homelessness. Counselors can provide you with information. You may contact: Mrs. Morgan, Counselor @ 841-8960.

****Parents are invited to participate in long-range planning , revisions of the School-Wide Plan, presenting input about Title 1 1% spending, as well as Parent/School Compacts, and of course, their student's academic learning. An Annual Meeting is held each school year at the beginning of school in August or September. Please make sure to attend this meeting as it presents pertinent information about your child's school year.*****

Subject To Change

This Student Handbook is provided as a convenience to the students of Tupelo Public School District. While it contains policies current at the time of printing, we are constantly reviewing and updating policies. Therefore, the Handbook may not always reflect the most current policy. All policies and procedures summarized in this Student Handbook are subject to unilateral change at the sole option and discretion of the Tupelo Public School District. A copy of the current policies of the Tupelo Public School District is available at www.tupeloschools.com as well as in the District Office.

You are ensured access of this electronic version of the handbook when you complete and sign Infosnap at registration for your child.